

INTERVIEW GUIDE FOR STUDENTS

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1. INTRODUCTION TO INTERVIEWS

What is an Interview?

An interview is a formal conversation between a candidate and an employer to assess suitability for a job or position. It's not just about testing knowledge — it's about evaluating your confidence, communication, and personality.

Purpose of an Interview

- To understand your skills and attitude.
- To judge how you handle pressure and communicate.
- To see if you fit into the organization's culture.

Types of Interviews

- **Personal Interview (PI)** – one-on-one.
 - **Group Discussion (GD)** – to assess teamwork and communication.
 - **Panel Interview** – multiple interviewers.
 - **Online/Virtual Interview** – through video conferencing.
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□ 2. RESUME / CV PREPARATION

Key Points

- Keep it **1 page** (for freshers).
- Use **clear headings**: Education, Skills, Achievements, Experience (if any).
- Start with **your name and contact info**.
- Mention **career objective** — short and realistic.
- Use **action verbs** (managed, organized, assisted, achieved).
- Don't include fake information — honesty builds credibility.

Example Career Objective:

“To utilize my communication and analytical skills in a professional environment where I can contribute and grow.”

Avoid:

- “To get a good job in a reputed company.”
 - “To develop my skills while adding value to the organization.”
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□ 3. COMMONLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Question	Sample Answer
Tell me about yourself.	“I’m [Name], a graduate in [Field] from [College]. I’m passionate about [Skill/Interest] and eager to learn through real-world experience.”
What are your strengths?	“I’m punctual, disciplined, and communicate clearly.”
What is your weakness?	“I used to be shy, but I’ve been working on speaking confidently in public.”
Why should we hire you?	“Because I’m sincere, adaptable, and committed to giving my best.”
Where do you see yourself in 5 years?	“In a responsible position where I can lead projects and contribute meaningfully.”
Any questions for us?	“What skills does your company value most in new employees?”

□ 4. DO’S AND DON’TS

✓ □ DO’S

- Be punctual (reach 15–20 minutes early).
- Greet politely with a smile.
- Maintain eye contact.
- Speak clearly and confidently.
- Listen carefully before answering.
- Thank the interviewer before leaving.

□ DON’TS

- Don’t interrupt the interviewer.
 - Don’t lie or exaggerate.
 - Don’t fidget, slouch, or play with your hair.
 - Don’t use slang or filler words like “umm,” “like,” “you know.”
 - Don’t forget to switch your phone to silent mode.
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□ 5. COMMON INTERVIEW VOCABULARY

Word / Phrase	Meaning / Usage
Strengths	Positive qualities or abilities.
Weaknesses	Areas where you can improve.
Profile	Job position or role.

Word / Phrase	Meaning / Usage
Responsibilities	Duties you are expected to perform.
Teamwork	Working well with others.
Adaptability	Ability to adjust to new situations.
Deadline	Final date to complete a task.
Skill set	Combination of your abilities and talents.
Experience	Past exposure or work done.
Candidate	A person being interviewed for a job.
Professionalism	Proper behavior and attitude at work.

☞ 6. BODY LANGUAGE & FIRST IMPRESSION

Positive Signs:

- Smile genuinely.
- Sit straight, hands relaxed.
- Nod slightly while listening.
- Maintain polite gestures.

Negative Signs:

- Crossing arms (defensive).
 - Looking around or down (nervousness).
 - Overusing hand movements.
 - Avoiding eye contact.
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☞ 7. ONLINE INTERVIEW TIPS

- Dress professionally even if it's virtual.
 - Choose a quiet, well-lit background.
 - Keep your resume open on screen (for quick reference).
 - Test mic and camera beforehand.
 - Look at the **camera**, not your own image.
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☞ 8. AFTER THE INTERVIEW

- Say, *"Thank you for the opportunity, it was a pleasure speaking with you."*
- Send a **thank-you email** within 24 hours.
- Note down questions you struggled with — and prepare better for next time.

